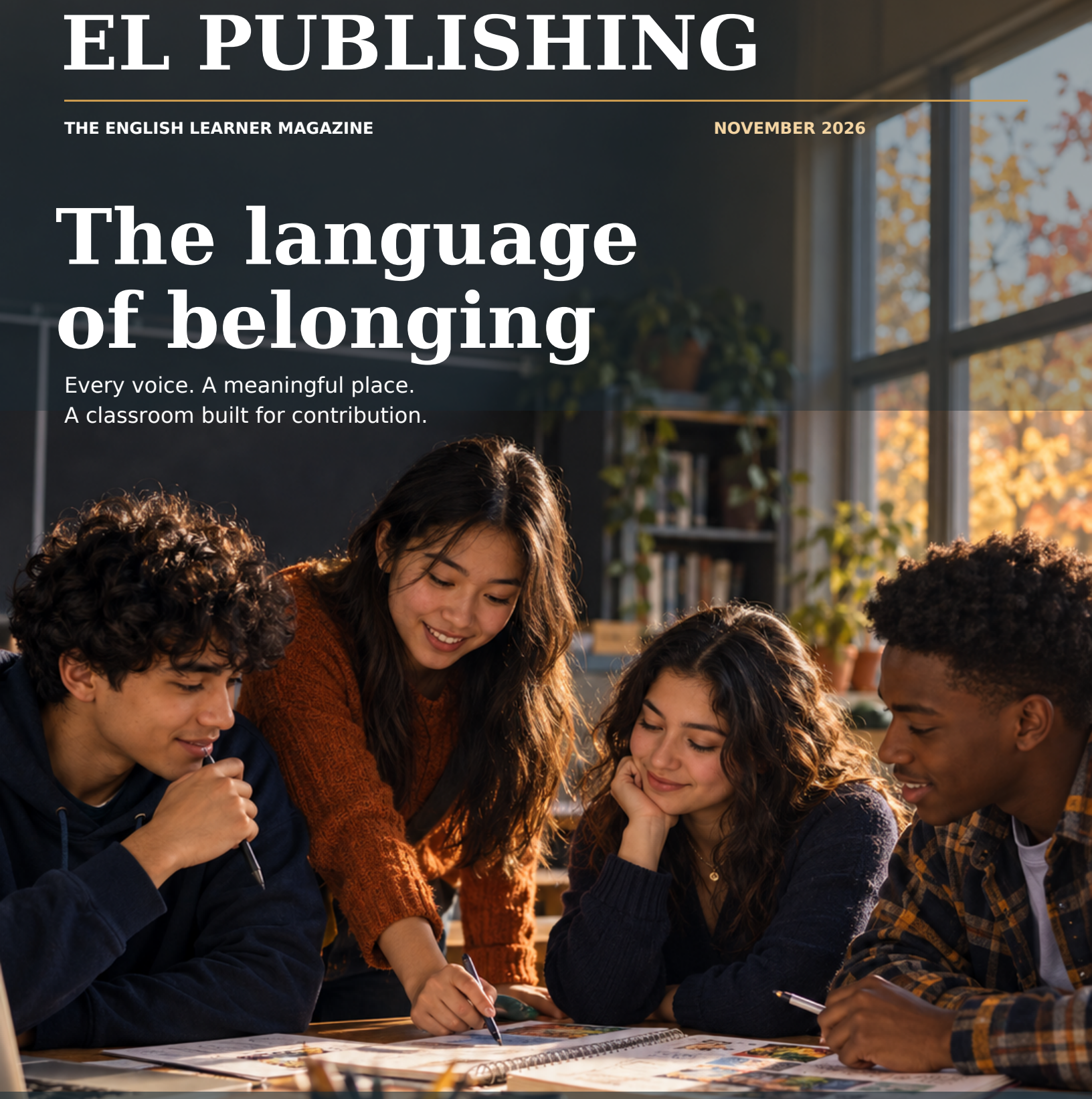
EL PUBLISHING

THE ENGLISH LEARNER MAGAZINE

NOVEMBER 2026

The language of belonging

Every voice. A meaningful place.
A classroom built for contribution.



THE FALL ISSUE

WHEN WELCOME BECOMES ACTION

Original stories, fresh teaching ideas, and student work with a purpose.

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The Empty Chair
A bilingual family page

26 PAGES / GRADES 9-12 / IDEAS TO READ, TEACH & SHARE

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The November edit.

Detailed features, original readings, and classroom ideas for grades 9-12.



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INDEPENDENT CLASSROOM EDITION. Original passages, scripts, and activities. Answer in a notebook or on separate paper. Not an official ELPA21 publication.

FROM THE EDITOR

A place for every voice.

November invites reflection. Let it also invite a clearer view of who participates, who is heard, and what makes participation possible.

Dear colleagues,

A student may understand a difficult idea before having the English to explain it. Another may speak comfortably with friends and still need support to build an academic argument. Neither learner should have to wait for perfect English to participate in meaningful work.

Belonging is something we design.

It appears in the way we pronounce a name, the examples we choose, the time we allow for rehearsal, and the questions we ask after a student speaks. It becomes visible when students can point to a contribution and say: I helped make this.

This November, teach toward voice.

Invite students to explain, compare, question, and create. Give them words that carry those purposes. Let them plan in a familiar language, test an idea with a partner, and return to English with something worth saying.

What this issue offers

The central theme is belonging through contribution. The nonfiction reading follows a student team making a school event more accessible. The fiction explores the difference between an invitation and a real opportunity to join. Students then turn those ideas into a publishable product.

How to use the supports

Emerging and progressing are planning labels here, not fixed descriptions of ability. A learner may need a phrase bank for speaking and greater independence in reading. Choose supports from current work samples and remove them as students gain control.

One goal, several entry points

Keep the thinking worthwhile: explain how a choice affects participation and support the explanation with evidence. Vary rehearsal, sentence support, text chunking, and response length. Revisit the same goal across all four language domains.

THE EDITORIAL PROMISE

Rich ideas. Accessible language. Student work that deserves an audience.

"Belonging is something we design."



TEACHING FEATURE / 1 OF 2

Belonging becomes visible.

A practical design approach: make the task understandable, make participation possible, and make student thinking public.

ACCESS
What are we doing?

REHEARSE
What could I say?

CONTRIBUTE
How can I help?

1. Make the goal concrete

Instead of announcing, "We are doing a discussion," name the purpose: "We will decide which change would help more students join a school event." Show a model response containing a claim and a reason. Point out the reasoning, then examine the language.

2. Separate the idea from the wording

Ask students to sketch or list a proposed change before composing sentences. Permit bilingual notes and dictionaries. During partner talk, listen for the underlying reasoning: Does the student explain how the change would help? Then coach the English needed to express that relationship.

3. Offer a useful role

Give each learner a contribution that advances the task: locate an event detail, ask a clarifying question, explain a barrier, or compare two proposals. Rotate these roles. Avoid making one confident speaker the permanent reporter.

A classroom snapshot

A group proposes a welcome sign. One student draws the entrance and points to where the sign should go. Another names the languages visitors might read. A third explains why symbols would also help. The teacher asks: "Which barrier does your design address?" All three students can contribute to that answer.

Watch the response, not just the room

A lively classroom can still hide unequal participation. Collect one short response from every student. Compare an initial explanation with a revised version after discussion. Look for more precise vocabulary, a clearer reason, or a better use of evidence.

Try this tomorrow

Write a question that requires a choice. Provide two possible answers and one open option. Allow silent planning, then paired rehearsal. Invite several explanations before naming the strongest evidence. End with an individual response so you can see each learner’s thinking.

TEACHING FEATURE / 2 OF 2

Same destination. Better supports.

Shared objective: explain how a specific action increases participation, using a detail from a text or observation.

EMERGING / MORE GUIDANCE

Make the meaning visible

Read the same text in short chunks with a teacher or partner. Preview four key words with pictures or quick sketches. Let the learner label a barrier, select a relevant detail, and rehearse a sentence before speaking.

"The students added ___. This helped because ___."

PROGRESSING / GROWING INDEPENDENCE

Make the connection explicit

Ask the learner to annotate a decision and its result. Provide an optional connector bank: because, however, therefore, for example. Require an explanation of how the evidence supports the claim. Invite a follow-up question.

"The change increased participation because ___. The detail ___ shows ___."

EXTENSION / GREATER PRECISION

Test the strength of the claim

Ask the learner to identify a remaining barrier, compare two solutions, or acknowledge a limitation. Require a response that connects evidence to a realistic next step. Increase independence before simply increasing length.

"Although ___ helped, ___ remained a barrier. A next step would be ___ because ___."

Teacher check: If a student can select accurate evidence but cannot explain it in English, keep the reasoning demand and add a language model. If the evidence is inaccurate, return to the text before adding more writing.

NOVEMBER WITH CARE

Whose voice tells the story?

Use Native American Heritage Month to practice accurate naming, contemporary perspectives, and thoughtful source selection.

Begin with specificity [2]

Native peoples are not one culture with one story. The Smithsonian's Native Knowledge 360° framework emphasizes the diversity and continuing presence of Native nations. Name the nation associated with a source, and distinguish a specific community's account from a claim about all Native peoples.

Make inquiry the activity

Choose a short, teacher-previewed resource from Native Knowledge 360°. Display its title, creator or institution, date if available, and the community it concerns. Ask students to distinguish what the source states from what they infer. Use present-tense questions about contemporary people as well as questions about history.

Give students an honest task

Students create a source card: "This resource is about ___. It was created by ___. One detail I learned is ___. One question I still have is ___." They should not invent a first-person Native identity or speak as representatives of a community.

A 20-minute source inquiry

Before / 4 minutes: Define source, perspective, and nation. Preview two needed words. Ask what students already know and mark uncertain ideas as questions.

During / 9 minutes: Read or view a selected excerpt twice. Students record two verifiable details and identify who is speaking.

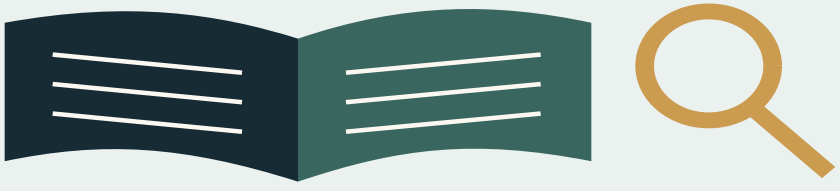
After / 7 minutes: Partners compare a detail and a question. Each student writes a two-sentence summary with the source title.

If Thanksgiving enters the lesson [3]

The museum offers materials for examining Thanksgiving stories through Native perspectives. Preview a resource for historical context and age appropriateness. Ask whose account is included, which details need support, and what another source might add. Do not use a classroom reenactment as historical evidence.

LANGUAGE FOR SOURCE TALK

"According to this source, ___."
"The creator's perspective is ___."
"This source does not tell us ___."



WHO SPEAKS?
WHAT IS SHOWN?
WHAT IS MISSING?

READING LAB / STUDENT TEXT

The Table We Built

Original informational narrative • Read to explain how a design choice changes who can participate.



1 / A problem at the doorway

When a student team planned a November community evening, they imagined a crowded room and lively conversations. They put a long table near the entrance and covered it with sign-up sheets. But during a practice visit, several classmates stopped at the door. They could not tell which sheet to use or what would happen after signing.

2 / A closer look

The team first suggested a bigger sign. Then Elena asked a different question: "What do visitors need to do, step by step?" The group walked through the event as if they were arriving for the first time. They noticed that the sign used unfamiliar school abbreviations. The directions also expected visitors to read quickly while others waited behind them.

3 / A practical redesign

The students replaced the abbreviations with everyday words. Beside each instruction, they added a simple symbol: an arrow for entering, a pencil for signing, and a speech bubble for asking a question. They invited bilingual classmates to help draft translations and asked an adult to review them. Then they moved the table away from the doorway so visitors would have space to pause.

4 / A second test

At the next practice visit, classmates followed the new directions more easily. One student still hesitated. He wanted to help but did not know which job he could do. The team added a short list of roles: welcome visitors, arrange chairs, check supplies, or explain the activity. They also offered a partner option so no one had to begin alone.

5 / What success looked like

On the evening of the event, the team watched how people used the space. They heard fewer questions about where to begin, but several visitors still asked about the schedule. Elena wrote this down. The team had improved the welcome, yet it had more work to do. A successful design, she decided, was something people could use - and something its makers were willing to revise.

6 / Beyond one evening

The next week, the group shared its notes with another club. Instead of giving the club a perfect plan, the team offered three questions: What might confuse a newcomer? What choices can a visitor make? How will we know whether our changes help? Their most useful product was not a table or a sign. It was a way to notice who was still waiting at the edge.

Quick glossary: abbreviations = shortened forms of words; hesitate = pause because you are uncertain; revise = change to improve. **Note:** This is a fictional classroom scenario, not a report of a real school event.

READING LAB / RESPONSE

Notice. Explain. Prove.

Use paragraph numbers from page 7. Answer in a notebook or on a separate sheet. Explain your thinking to a partner before writing.

A / Build understanding

1. What is the central idea?
A. Bigger signs solve every event problem.
B. Observing and revising can improve participation.
C. Visitors should learn school abbreviations.
D. Working alone is better than using a partner.

2. Why did the team walk through the event in paragraph 2?
A. To finish decorating the room.
B. To find the shortest route home.
C. To see the experience from a visitor's view.
D. To decide which club should attend.

B / Follow the evidence

3. In paragraph 4, what does *hesitated* most nearly mean?
A. Celebrated loudly
B. Completed a job
C. Explained clearly
D. Paused with uncertainty

4. Name two changes from paragraph 3 and explain the barrier each change addressed.

C / Read the limitation

5. Which detail shows that the redesign was not complete? Explain why that detail matters to the central idea.

D / Make an inference

6. What can you infer about Elena's view of leadership? Use one action or statement as evidence.

7. The author ends with students "waiting at the edge." Does the phrase refer only to physical location? Explain its broader meaning in the passage.

E / Turn reading into action

8. Choose a school task, such as finding a classroom or joining a club. Propose one change that would make participation easier. Explain how you would check whether it worked.

Language support

Start here: "The team changed ___. This helped visitors ___."

Build further: "In paragraph ___, the detail ___ supports the idea that ___ because ___."

Stretch: "Although the team improved ___, ___ remained a barrier. This suggests ___."

CHECK BEFORE YOU FINISH

Underline your claim. Circle the paragraph number or evidence. Draw an arrow to the explanation that connects them.

VOICE STUDIO / LISTENING

A message worth catching.

Teacher-read script • Two listens • Original practice, not an official test item. Cover the script while students listen.

Teacher script

"Good afternoon, welcome team. Our community evening begins at five thirty on Thursday. Volunteers should arrive at five fifteen so we have time to review the room. Please use the side entrance because the front hallway is being cleaned.

"We have changed two parts of the plan. First, the sign-up table will be beside the library, not inside the doorway. This will leave more room for visitors to enter. Second, volunteers may choose to work with a partner. If you are unsure about a job, ask Ms. Rivera before the event begins.

"Bring your name card, but do not bring extra decorations. We already have enough. If your family needs the schedule in another language, tell us today so we can arrange help. Before you leave, please check the role list and confirm your arrival time."

Delivery notes

Read at a natural, clear pace. First listen: no writing except a topic word. Second listen: students take notes. A third listen can be an instructional support; record that support when comparing work samples. Show the written script only after collecting listening responses.

Listen 1 / Purpose

1. What is the main purpose of the announcement?
A. To explain a canceled event
B. To prepare volunteers for an event
C. To describe library books
D. To invite students to decorate

Listen 2 / Details

2. What time should volunteers arrive?
3. Which entrance should they use, and why?
4. Where will the sign-up table be?
5. What should volunteers bring?
6. What should a volunteer do if unsure about a job?

After listening / Reasoning

7. Explain how moving the table could help visitors. Use a detail from the message.

8. What should a student do if their family needs the schedule in another language?

A useful note grid

WHEN: event / volunteer arrival
WHERE: entrance / table
DO: bring / check / ask

For emerging students, provide icons for a clock, door, table, and name card. Keep the spoken content unchanged.



VOICE STUDIO / SPEAKING

Your idea. Your evidence. Your voice.

Partner task: recommend one change that makes a school event more welcoming. Plan, rehearse, respond, and revise.

1

PLAN

Choose a barrier.

2

REHEARSE

Try a reason.

3

RESPOND

Answer a question.

The prompt

Your school is hosting an after-school event for students and families. Some visitors may be unfamiliar with the building, the language on the signs, or the jobs available. Recommend one practical change. Explain who it helps and how it helps. Use an example from page 7 or page 9.

Round 1 / 45-60 seconds

Speaker: give a recommendation and a reason. Listener: take notes using "change / reason / example." Then ask one clarifying question. Switch roles. Time is a target for practice; do not penalize a useful shorter response from a learner who needs support.

Round 2 / Improve one move

Repeat the response with one improvement: a more precise verb, a clearer connection, or a detail that actually supports the recommendation. The listener names the improvement heard.

Choose your support

More guidance: sketch the change, label it in any language, and use: "I recommend ___. It helps ___ because ___."

Growing independence: use: "One barrier is ___. A useful change would be ___. For example, ___."

Extension: explain a trade-off: "This would help ___; however, ___. We could address that by ___."

Questions that keep talk going

"Who would benefit most?"
"What in the text gave you that idea?"
"How would you know it worked?"
"Could you explain what you mean by ___?"

Feedback that helps

Say: "Your reason was clear when you ___." Then suggest one change: "Add an example of ___." Avoid rating an accent. Attend to whether the listener can follow the message and the reasoning.

SAVE THE GROWTH

Keep a first and revised response, or use a teacher checklist. Record the support used so the comparison remains useful.

LANGUAGE WORKSHOP / GRAMMAR

Small connectors. Big meaning.

Use because to explain a reason, but to show contrast, and so to connect an action or situation to a result.

BECAUSE	BUT	SO
reason	contrast	result

Read the difference

Reason: We moved the table because the doorway was crowded.

Contrast: The sign was large, but the words were confusing.

Result: The doorway was crowded, so we moved the table.

Notice that the order of ideas matters. *Because* introduces the reason. *So* introduces the result.

A / Choose the connector

1. We added pictures ___ some visitors were still learning the words.
2. The room was small, ___ we used the larger library.
3. The directions were short, ___ the abbreviations were confusing.
4. Luis practiced his explanation, ___ he felt more prepared.

B / Combine the ideas

5. We printed a map. Visitors could find the library. Use *so*.
6. The team revised the sign. Some words were unfamiliar. Use *because*.

C / Repair the meaning

7. A student writes: "We added arrows, but visitors could follow the route." If the second idea is the expected result of adding arrows, which connector fits better? Rewrite the sentence.

8. Revise this fragment into a complete thought: "Because the hallway was crowded."

D / Apply it to a real choice

Write three sentences about an improvement to your classroom. Include a reason, a contrast, and a result. Underline the connector in each sentence. Ask a partner to name the relationship without looking at your label.

Teacher mini-lesson / 7 minutes

Model a pair of ideas with arrows. Ask whether the second idea is a reason, an unexpected contrast, or a result. Let students choose a connector and justify it. Teach punctuation in the model sentence; keep the first feedback focused on the intended relationship.

SPANISH BRIDGE

because / porque
but / pero
so / así que
Choose the meaning that fits the sentence.

LANGUAGE WORKSHOP / VOCABULARY

Words that open the door.

Study the word, use it in a meaningful phrase, and explain it in a new context. Spanish is one optional bridge; invite other languages too.

participate

participar

take part in an activity

Students participate in a discussion.

contribute

contribuir

give an idea, effort, or resource

Each partner contributes one reason.

revise

revisar / modificar

change something to improve it

We revise the directions after testing them.

evidence

evidencia / pruebas

details that support an explanation

The paragraph provides evidence for the claim.

perspective

perspectiva

a way of seeing or understanding

Read the sign from a visitor’s perspective.

accessible

accesible

possible to reach, use, or understand

Clear labels make the task more accessible.

A / Word-family builder

Complete each sentence with *participate*, *participation*, or *participant*.

1. Each ___ chose a job.
2. More students could ___ after the change.
3. The team wanted to increase ___.

Explain what changed when the word became a person, an action, or an idea.

B / Meaning detective

4. In this issue, does *revise* mean only to check for spelling? Explain with a text example.
5. Give one example of a barrier and one way to make a task more accessible.
6. Write a new sentence using *evidence*. Include the detail being used as evidence.



LITERARY LENS / ORIGINAL FICTION

The Empty Chair

A short story about an invitation, a missing choice, and the moment a student decides to speak.

THE LANGUAGE OF BELONGING / NOVEMBER FEATURE

1

Mara carried her tray past the art-room door twice. Inside, students were painting signs for the November showcase. Someone had placed an empty chair at the end of the table. Above it, a paper sign said EVERYONE WELCOME. Mara read the words, then kept walking.

2

On Tuesday, Mr. Bell noticed her pause. "You can join them," he said. Mara nodded. She wanted to say that joining was not the same as knowing what to do. Instead, she pointed toward the cafeteria and hurried away.

3

The next day, a student named Jamal came out with blue paint on his sleeve. "We need someone to check our map," he said. "Does this arrow make sense?" He held up a sketch of the hallway. Mara looked at it. The arrow pointed toward a locked storage room.

4

"Library is here," she said, touching the other side of the page. Jamal studied the sketch. "You’re right. Will you show us?" This time, Mara followed him inside. The empty chair had three paintbrushes on it. She moved them to the table and sat down.

5

As the group worked, Mara drew a small square beside each room on the map. "Color," she said. "Same color on door." Jamal found colored paper. Another student began cutting matching squares. Soon, a visitor could follow the blue marks to the library and the yellow marks to the gym.

6

At the end of the afternoon, Mr. Bell stopped beside the table. "I’m glad you found the welcome sign," he told Mara. She looked at the words above the chair. Then she looked at the map. "The sign was nice," she said carefully. "But he asked me a question." She pointed to Jamal.

7

On Friday, the group made one more sign. It did not replace EVERYONE WELCOME. It hung beside it. Under the words WHAT CAN YOU HELP US NOTICE? they left space for visitors to write. Mara tested a marker, drew a small blue arrow in the corner, and placed the first chair where someone could easily reach it.

Read with a pencil: Mark the turning point. Box one object that changes meaning. Put a star beside a line that reveals the difference between being invited and being included.

LITERARY LENS / ANALYSIS

From an empty chair to a real role.

A shared literary objective: explain how a character’s actions and a recurring object develop a theme.

A / Establish what happens

1. Why does Mara initially walk past the art room?
A. She dislikes maps.
B. She is told to leave.
C. She wants to join but does not know how.
D. She is already leading another project.

2. Which event begins to change Mara’s participation?
A. Mr. Bell points to the cafeteria.
B. Jamal asks her to check the map.
C. The showcase ends.
D. The group removes every sign.

B / Interpret the craft

3. What do the paintbrushes on the empty chair suggest about the group’s welcome? Use the surrounding events to support your interpretation.

4. Compare Mara’s actions in paragraphs 1 and 7. What has changed?

C / Build a theme

5. Write a theme as a complete sentence rather than a one-word topic. Support it with two details from different parts of the story.

D / Read the dialogue

6. Explain why Mara says, "But he asked me a question." What does her response reveal about what helped her join?

7. Does the story suggest that welcome signs have no value? Explain how the ending helps you answer.

Make the thinking accessible

More guidance: place three moments in order: Mara passes the door / Jamal asks about the map / Mara helps design a sign. Match each moment to a feeling or motivation and explain one match.

Growing independence: write a paragraph connecting the turning point to a theme. Use one direct detail and one paraphrase.

Extension: explain how the chair and the map function differently as symbols.

Discussion bridge

"An invitation becomes meaningful when ___."
"At first, the chair suggests ___. Later, it suggests ___."
"The line ___ matters because ___."





WRITING WORKSHOP

Write appreciation with precision.

A sincere note names an action, explains its effect, and recognizes the person behind it. A fictional recipient is always an option.

THE LANGUAGE OF BELONGING / NOVEMBER FEATURE

The mentor note / original

Dear Ms. Chen,

Thank you for showing me how to check the lab directions before I started. When you drew the first step and asked me to explain it back, I knew what to do next. Your patience helped me take part in the experiment instead of waiting for someone else to finish. Next time, I want to use that same strategy to help a partner.

Sincerely,
A grateful student

Notice the structure

Action: What exactly did the person do?
Impact: What changed for the writer?
Reflection: Why did that change matter?
Next step: How might the writer carry it forward?

Plan before you draft

Make four quick notes: person / specific action / effect / meaning. Plan in any language. Decide which details belong in the final note and which are private. You may thank a fictional character for a fictional action.

Your writing task

Write a note of approximately 80-120 words to someone whose action made a task easier, clearer, or more welcoming. Include a concrete detail and an explanation of its effect. Adapt the length to the support needed; the reasoning matters more than the word count.

A frame you can outgrow

"Thank you for ___. When you ___, I was able to ___. This mattered because ___. I will remember ___."

For greater independence, vary sentence beginnings and connect the action to a wider idea about learning or community.

Revise for meaning

Replace "You are nice" with an action a reader can picture. Replace "It helped a lot" with an explanation of what became possible. Read the note aloud. Does every pronoun have a clear referent? Does the tone fit the recipient?

Partner conference

The reader underlines the specific action and circles its effect. If either is missing, ask a question rather than supplying a sentence. The writer decides how to revise.

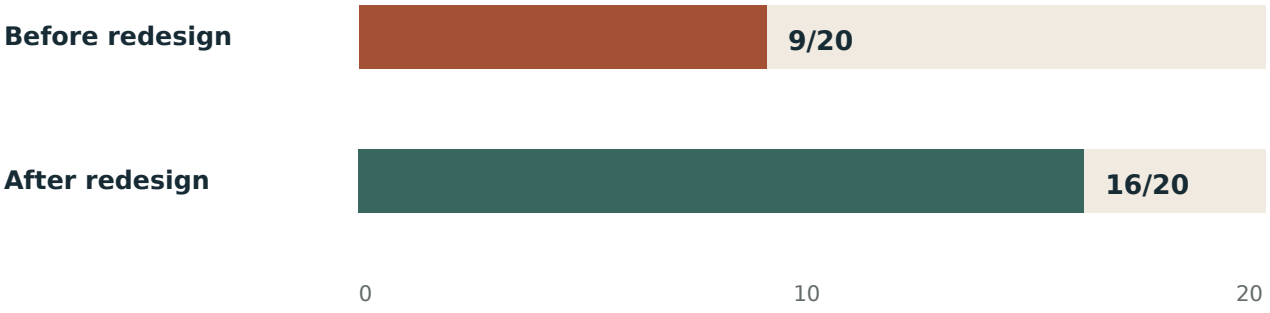
VISUAL LITERACY / CLASSROOM DATA

A graph needs a careful reader.

The numbers below are invented for this lesson. They represent a fictional practice visit, not research findings or actual school results.

Visitors who found the correct starting point

Two separate groups of 20 visitors • Fictional classroom data



Read the information

1. How many visitors found the starting point before the redesign?
2. How many did so afterward?
3. How many more visitors found it afterward?
4. What fraction and percentage of the second group found it?

Show your calculation, not only your answer.

Say what the graph supports

5. Write one accurate comparison using *more than* or *increased from*.
6. Does the graph show that every visitor understood every direction? Explain.

Question the conclusion

7. A student says, "The redesign definitely caused all of the improvement." What information would you need before making that strong a claim?

8. Name one question this graph cannot answer. Explain what additional information would help.

Language support

"The number increased from ___ to ___."
"That is ___ more visitors."
"The graph suggests ___, but it does not show ___."

Teacher note: distinguish a count difference from a percentage-point difference. Before: 45%. After: 80%. The change is 35 percentage points.



STUDENT PUBLISHING PROJECT

Make a one-page belonging guide.

Essential question: How can a student-created guide help someone participate more confidently in school life?

THE LANGUAGE OF BELONGING / NOVEMBER FEATURE

The product

Create one page for a real or imagined newcomer to a school activity. Choose a practical focus: joining a club, locating a classroom, using the library, or preparing for an event. Include a clear title, three sequenced steps, a labeled visual, a useful question, and one source or reviewer credit.

The process / three sessions

Session 1 / Notice and plan: walk through the task or use a teacher-provided scenario. Identify one barrier. Sketch the guide and draft directions. Decide what a reader needs first.

Session 2 / Test and revise: ask a partner unfamiliar with your draft to follow it. Observe without explaining. Ask: "Where did you hesitate?" Record one revision and why it matters.

Session 3 / Publish and explain: finalize the page. Present the barrier, the design choice, and the evidence from your test. Explain one remaining limitation.

Design requirements

Use readable headings and a clear order. Pair symbols with words rather than relying only on color. If you include translations, ask a proficient reader to review them. Mark a draft translation as unreviewed until it is checked. Use your own drawings or appropriately credited images.

Language requirements

Include at least one sentence with a reason and one with a result. Use a precise action verb in each step. Add a question the reader could ask when confused. Bilingual planning is welcome; the English version should communicate the essential steps.

Assess the thinking

Ask each student: What barrier did you notice? Which choice addresses it? What did your reader do during the test? What changed after feedback? Score the explanation and the product separately when a group has collaborated.

AN AUDIENCE GIVES THE WORK PURPOSE

Share with a partner class, display in the classroom, or compile a class magazine. Check permissions before posting identifiable student work publicly.

FAMILY CONNECTION / ENGLISH + SPANISH

A conversation, not an assignment.

Optional take-home page • Students may respond privately, use a fictional example, or pass on any personal question.

ENGLISH

Dear families,

This month, our class is exploring how clear language and thoughtful actions help people participate. Students will read, discuss, and create a short guide that makes a school task easier to understand.

An optional conversation

In any language, talk about one of these questions:

1. What helps someone feel welcome in a new place?
2. When have clear directions made a task easier?
3. What is one helpful thing a new student should know about school?

A simple response

Your student may bring one idea, a short note, or a drawing. No purchase, photograph, or personal story is required. A made-up example is welcome.

Student reflection

One idea I heard or imagined was ___.

It connects to our class work because ___.

ESPAÑOL

Estimadas familias:

Este mes, nuestra clase explora cómo el lenguaje claro y las acciones consideradas ayudan a las personas a participar. Los estudiantes leerán, conversarán y crearán una guía breve que facilite la comprensión de una tarea escolar.

Una conversación opcional

En cualquier idioma, conversen sobre una de estas preguntas:

1. ¿Qué ayuda a una persona a sentirse bienvenida en un lugar nuevo?
2. ¿Cuándo han facilitado una tarea las instrucciones claras?
3. ¿Qué información útil debería conocer un estudiante nuevo?

Una respuesta sencilla

Su estudiante puede traer una idea, una nota breve o un dibujo. No se requiere ninguna compra, fotografía ni historia personal. También puede usar un ejemplo inventado.

Reflexión del estudiante

Una idea que escuché o imaginé fue ___.

Se relaciona con nuestro trabajo en clase porque ___.

TEACHER PLANNER / FULL LESSON

A complete 90-minute block.

Shared goal: explain how a design choice improves participation, using one relevant detail and a clear reason.

00-08

Notice + wonder

Display an unfamiliar direction such as "Report to RM 204 for PM sign-in." Ask what a newcomer might need clarified. Collect one question from each student.

08-18

Words + model

Preview barrier, revise, participate, and evidence. Model: "The words were unfamiliar, so the team added symbols." Students sketch a barrier and name a possible support.

18-35

Read + mark

Read page 7 in chunks. Students mark a barrier, a change, and a result. Emerging learners rehearse after each chunk; progressing learners add paragraph references.

35-47

Compare evidence

Use page 8, questions 4 and 5. Partners explain one change and one limitation. Collect a two-sentence individual response before moving on.

47-57

Listen + organize

Read the page 9 script twice. Students use the WHEN / WHERE / DO grid and answer questions 2-5. Briefly confirm details without displaying the script first.

57-70

Speak + respond

Use page 10. Each partner recommends a change, provides a reason, and answers one clarifying question. Teacher listens to a rotating group of students.

70-84

Write + revise

Students draft a short recommendation with a claim, a text detail, and a reason. Use the page 11 connector models. Partners identify the evidence-to-reason link.

84-90

Exit + next step

Students submit: "One change I recommend is ___. My evidence is ___. It would help because ___." Sort work into evidence, explanation, or language-support needs.

Suggested ELP connections [1]: make meaning from text and speech; exchange ideas; explain a topic; support a claim; organize a clear message. Materials: pages 7-11, notebooks, pencils, and a timer. These are instructional connections, not an official alignment certification.

TEACHER PLANNER / MONTH MAP

Fifteen lessons. One coherent arc.

Use three five-lesson cycles in November. Adapt to your school calendar; these are lesson numbers, not assigned dates or assumptions about holidays.

CYCLE 1 / Understand the problem

01	**Belonging audit**	Observe a school task; sketch one barrier.
02	**Informational reading**	Read p. 7; mark problem / change / result.
03	**Evidence workshop**	Use p. 8; justify one answer with a detail.
04	**Listening studio**	Use p. 9; compare notes after two listens.
05	**Speaking rehearsal**	Use p. 10; save an initial and revised response.

CYCLE 2 / Develop the language

06	**Connector lab**	Use p. 11; explain reason, contrast, and result.
07	**Word-family lab**	Use p. 12; apply target words in new contexts.
08	**Fiction reading**	Read p. 13; locate the turning point.
09	**Theme + evidence**	Use p. 14; connect two details to a theme.
10	**Appreciation writing**	Use p. 15; revise an action-and-impact note.

CYCLE 3 / Create and reflect

11	**Source inquiry**	Use p. 6; summarize a previewed Native-authored or museum source.
12	**Read a graph**	Use p. 16; compare data and limit a claim.
13	**Guide design**	Use p. 17; draft steps and a labeled visual.
14	**Test + publish**	Observe a reader; revise and explain a choice.
15	**Show the growth**	Use pp. 21-22; compare work and choose a next step.

Domain balance: reading anchors the first two cycles; listening and speaking recur through rehearsal and source talk; writing develops from short evidence responses to a finished guide. Add brief retrieval and oral review between lessons.

STUDENT CHECK / ORIGINAL PRACTICE

Can you explain what changed?

Name: _____ Date: _____
This classroom check is not an official ELPA21 task or score. Keep the text available.

Read: A school club posted a flyer that said, "Join us after school." Several students wanted to attend, but the flyer did not name the room or explain the activity. The club revised it to include a room number, a small map, and three examples of jobs. At the next meeting, more new students arrived. Some still asked when the meeting would end. The club decided to add the ending time to its next flyer.

A / Read and reason

1. Central idea / 1 point
A. School clubs should avoid flyers.
B. Maps are the only useful directions.
C. Clear details can help participation, and revision can continue.
D. Every student understood the new flyer.

2. Evidence / 2 points
Name two useful details added to the flyer.

3. Limitation / 2 points
What information was still missing? Which part of the text helps you know?

B / Use language

4. Connector / 1 point
The flyer lacked a room number, ___ some students did not know where to go.
A. because B. so C. but

5. Rewrite / 2 points
Combine with *because*: "The club added a map. Students needed to find the room."

C / Explain a choice

6. Written response / 4 points
Recommend one additional improvement to the flyer. Use a detail from the text and explain why your improvement would help. Write 3-5 sentences, or use a supported response agreed on with your teacher.

"I recommend ___. The text says ___. This would help because ___."

D / Speak and listen

7. Oral response / record separately
Tell a partner which improvement you recommend and why. Your partner asks a clarifying question. Answer it, then summarize your partner's recommendation. Use the rubric on page 22 for descriptive feedback.

Teacher recording

Reading + language: ___ / 8
Writing: ___ / 4
Speaking observations: _____
Listening observations: _____
Support used: _____

Do not convert this total into an ELPA21 proficiency level.

TEACHER DESK / CLASSROOM RUBRIC

Describe growth with useful evidence.

Use the rubric for the guide, a recommendation paragraph, or a speaking response. These local categories do not represent official proficiency levels.

CRITERION	1 / STARTING	2 / DEVELOPING	3 / EXTENDING
MEANING	States a relevant idea.	States a clear idea with a reason.	Develops a focused idea and explains why it matters.
EVIDENCE	Names a detail; connection may need prompting.	Uses a relevant detail connected to the idea.	Selects precise evidence and explains the connection.
ORGANIZATION	Ideas can be followed with support.	Sequences ideas with useful links.	Uses purposeful sequencing and clear relationships.
LANGUAGE	Uses familiar words or frames to convey meaning.	Uses topic words and sentences that generally carry meaning.	Uses precise wording and varied sentences suited to the task.

Use the descriptors carefully

Mark each criterion separately. A student can have strong reasoning and developing English control. Record the prompt, date, and supports. If there is no work sample, record "not yet observed" rather than assigning a low score.

Speaking and listening lens

For speaking, note whether the message can be followed and whether the student responds to the question. For listening, ask for an accurate summary or a response tied to what the partner actually said.

Student self-check

"My strongest move was ___."
"One detail that supports my idea is ___."
"The support that helped was ___."
"Next time I will ___."

Feedback formula

Name the successful move, identify one need, and give an action. Example: "Your claim is clear. The detail is relevant, but the link is missing. Add a sentence explaining how the map helped visitors find the room."

TEACHER DESK / ANSWER KEY

Read for meaning. Respond with evidence.

Accept accurate paraphrases. Open-response samples illustrate reasoning; students do not need to reproduce the wording.

Page 8 / The Table We Built

1. B. The team observes barriers and revises its design.
2. C. The walkthrough shows the event from a visitor's perspective.
3. D. He pauses because he is unsure.
4. Examples: everyday words address unfamiliar abbreviations; symbols offer another way to follow steps; reviewed translations support readers of other languages; moving the table gives visitors space to pause. Credit two changes with an explained barrier.
5. Visitors still ask about the schedule (paragraph 5). Improvement does not remove the need for further revision.
6. Elena treats leadership as noticing problems and using feedback; she records remaining questions instead of declaring the work complete.
7. "At the edge" also suggests being excluded or unsure how to participate.
8. Answers vary; look for a practical change and a way to observe its effect.

Page 9 / Listening

1. B.
2. 5:15.
3. Side entrance; the front hallway is being cleaned.
4. Beside the library.
5. A name card.
6. Ask Ms. Rivera before the event.
7. It leaves more room for visitors to enter.
8. Tell the team today so help can be arranged.

Page 11 / Grammar

1. because.
2. so.
3. but.
4. so.
5. "We printed a map so visitors could find the library." Also accept a comma plus *so* if the sentence clearly expresses the intended result.
6. "The team revised the sign because some words were unfamiliar."
7. "We added arrows, so visitors could follow the route."
8. Example: "Because the hallway was crowded, we moved the table." Accept any complete sentence with a sensible main clause.
Application: check whether the chosen connectors match the intended relationships.

Page 12 / Vocabulary

1. participant.
2. participate.
3. participation.
4. No. The team changes layout, wording, and roles; revision goes beyond spelling.
5. Example: unfamiliar room names are a barrier; a labeled map can help.
6. Example: "The visitors' questions are evidence that the schedule needs clearer directions." Credit a sentence using a supporting detail accurately.

Teaching reminder

A correct option without an explanation may conceal guessing. When evidence is the goal, ask the student to point to the detail and explain its relevance.

TEACHER DESK / ANSWER KEY

Interpret. Compare. Decide what comes next.

Use the keys to identify the next teaching move, not simply to mark a page complete.

Page 14 / The Empty Chair

1. C.
2. B.
3. The chair is labeled as open, but it is being used for supplies. It suggests that an invitation has not yet become a practical place or role for Mara.
4. At first she stays outside; at the end she helps shape the welcome for others. She has become a contributor.
5. Possible theme: genuine inclusion gives people meaningful ways to contribute. Evidence: Jamal asks for her judgment; the group uses her color idea; the final sign asks visitors to notice something.
6. The question gives her expertise a purpose and creates a manageable first action.
7. No. The group keeps the first sign and adds a more specific invitation. The story values a welcome paired with action.

Page 16 / Visual literacy

1. 9 visitors.
2. 16 visitors.
3. 7 more visitors.
4. 16/20 = 4/5 = 80%.
5. Example: "The number increased from 9 to 16."
6. No. It measures finding the starting point, not understanding every direction.
7. We need information about group differences, conditions, and what else changed. Two separate groups alone do not establish cause.
8. Example: which sign helped most? Ask visitors or test specific features separately.

Page 21 / Classroom check

1. C / 1 point.
2. Any two: room number, small map, examples of jobs / 1 point each.
3. Ending time / 1 point; students still asked when the meeting would end / 1 point.
4. B, so / 1 point.
5. "The club added a map because students needed to find the room." / 1 point for a complete sentence; 1 for a sensible reason relationship.
6. 1 point each: clear recommendation; relevant text detail; explanation linking the recommendation to participation; comprehensible connected message. Sample: "Add an ending time. The text says students asked when the meeting would end. That detail would help them plan their rides."
7. No contribution to the 12-point total. Use descriptive speaking and listening observations.

From an error to a next step

Evidence missing: return to one paragraph, offer two details, and ask which supports the claim.

Reasoning missing: model "This matters because..." and ask for a new explanation.

Language obscures meaning: rehearse orally, offer a targeted frame, then invite a revision.

Ready for extension: ask for a limitation, a counterexample, or a second source.

SOURCES + ISSUE NOTES

Grounded resources. Original classroom work.

A transparent guide to the sources behind the editorial guidance and to the materials created for this issue.

[1] English language proficiency

ELPA21. The ELP Standards. Official overview of the framework and its organization. Used for general language-purpose connections on page 19 and to inform the issue's emphasis on meaningful communication.

elpa21.org/elp-standards/

ELPA21. Resources. Official gateway to the complete standards and related documents. Consult the full grade-band descriptors when making local instructional plans.

elpa21.org/resources/

[2] Native perspectives

National Museum of the American Indian. Native Knowledge 360°: Essential Understandings. Used for page 6 guidance on cultural diversity, specificity, and contemporary presence.

americanindian.si.edu/nk360/about/essential-understandings

[3] Thanksgiving inquiry

National Museum of the American Indian. Native Knowledge 360°. Gateway to lessons and resources, including "The 'First Thanksgiving': How Can We Tell a Better Story?" Used as an optional teacher-previewed inquiry resource on page 6.

americanindian.si.edu/nk360

Editorial and production notes

Source pages consulted October 31, 2026. Activities, lesson structures, differentiation suggestions, rubrics, passages, and fictional scenarios were created for this issue. The data on page 16 are explicitly simulated. No school outcome or research effect size is claimed.

Scope and use

Designed primarily for mixed emerging and progressing ENL classes in grades 9-12. Supports are examples for teacher selection, not formal proficiency classifications. This issue does not establish state compliance, service minutes, or assessment policy. Editorial photographs are AI-generated illustrations, not images of actual students or documented school events. Charts and instructional graphics are vector artwork.

Classroom copies

Student-facing tasks can be answered in notebooks or on separate paper. The family page may be used independently. Preview external resources and adapt materials to your students and local instructional requirements.

Leave room for another voice.

A five-day challenge for a more welcoming classroom.

MONDAY	**NOTICE** Find one direction a newcomer might not understand.
TUESDAY	**CLARIFY** Replace an abbreviation with clear words or a labeled visual.
WEDNESDAY	**INVITE** Ask someone for a specific idea you have not yet heard.
THURSDAY	**LISTEN** Restate a partner’s idea before adding your own.
FRIDAY	**REFLECT** Name a change, its effect, and one next step.

Every language carries a life.
Every learner deserves a place to contribute.